

## **Desktop publishing (DTP)**

**Publishing** is the process of producing publications like greeting cards, magazines, flyers, newspapers, Newsletter, brochures, pamphlets, books, calendar that have special text, graphic layout and design.

**Desktop publishing** is a term coined after the development of a specific type of software. It's about using that software to combine and rearrange text and images and creating digital files for print, online viewing, or websites. and also produce typographic quality text and images comparable to **traditional typography** and printing.

- The traditional method of publishing (typography) involved drawing and writing manually on wooden or metallic boards. The artwork was then painted with ink and pressed on papers to produce a printout. This was very tedious and time consuming.
- Today the art of publishing has changed because of the advent of personal computers and smaller printers that are able to print high quality text and graphics, even in an office or at home.
- The term desktop means that all the **publishing process** can now be done on a desk in the office or at home using a personal computer.

**Desktop publishing** therefore refers to the process of inserting, editing, formatting, and printing of publications like greeting cards, magazines, flyers, newspapers, newsletters, brochure, pamphlets and books by designing their text, graphic layout of the text and graphical objects using a desktop publishing software installed on computer.

This technology allows individuals, businesses, and other organizations to self-publish a wide range of printed matter. Desktop publishing is also the main reference for **digital typography**. When used skillfully, desktop publishing allows the user to produce a wide variety of materials, from menus to magazines and books, without the expense of commercial printing.

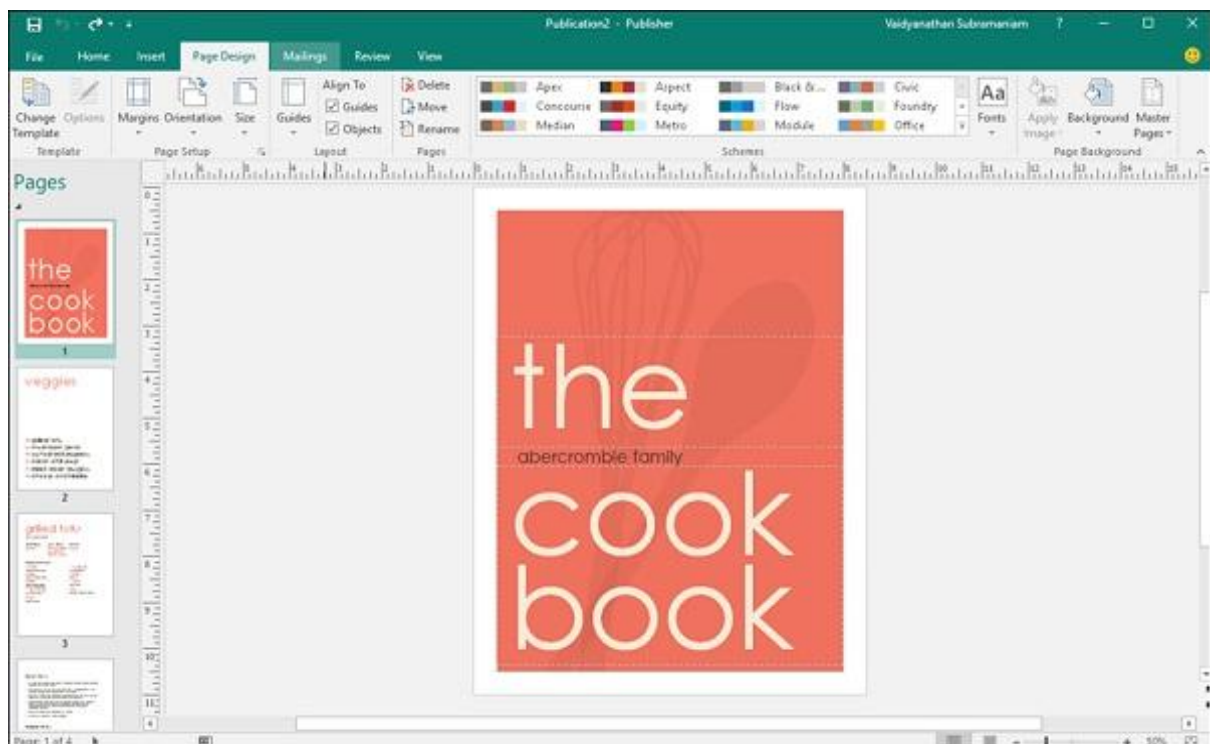
**Furthermore**, Desktop publishing can also be referred to as the process of producing publications by designing their text and graphics layout using special desktop publishing software installed on personal computers. The text and graphical objects can then be inserted, edited, formatted and printed.

### **Examples of DTP software;**

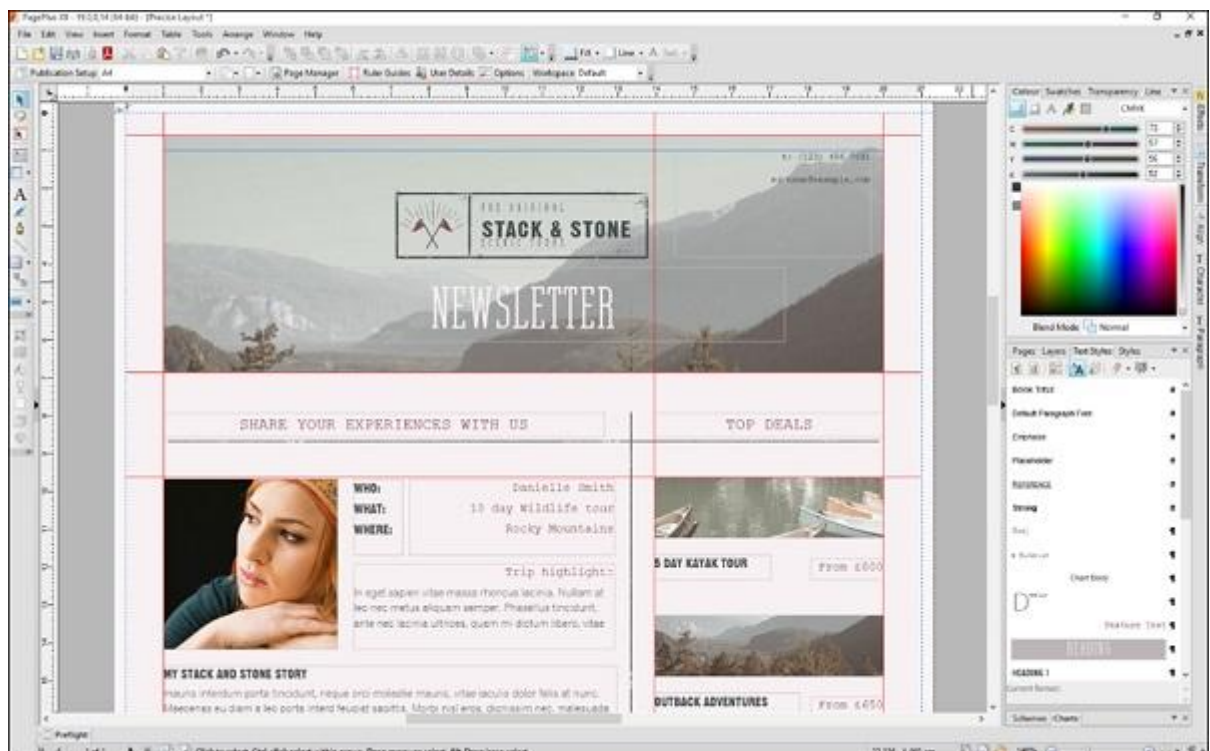
**Desktop-publishing software** can be used to create the layout for a wide range of different publications, such as: newspapers and magazines, newsletter. brochures, posters, flyer, leaflets and catalogues, books, e-books and PDF, web pages, banner, design of resume

- |                         |                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| i. Adobe PageMaker      | viii. Adobe Creative Cloud |
| ii. Microsoft Publisher | ix. Adobe InDesign CC      |
| iii. QuarkXPress        | x. Harvard Graphics.       |
| iv. Adobe InDesign      |                            |
| v. Ventura              |                            |
| vi. Serif PagePlus      |                            |
| vii. Apple Page 2.      |                            |

Some of their DTP Software interfaces are presented here;



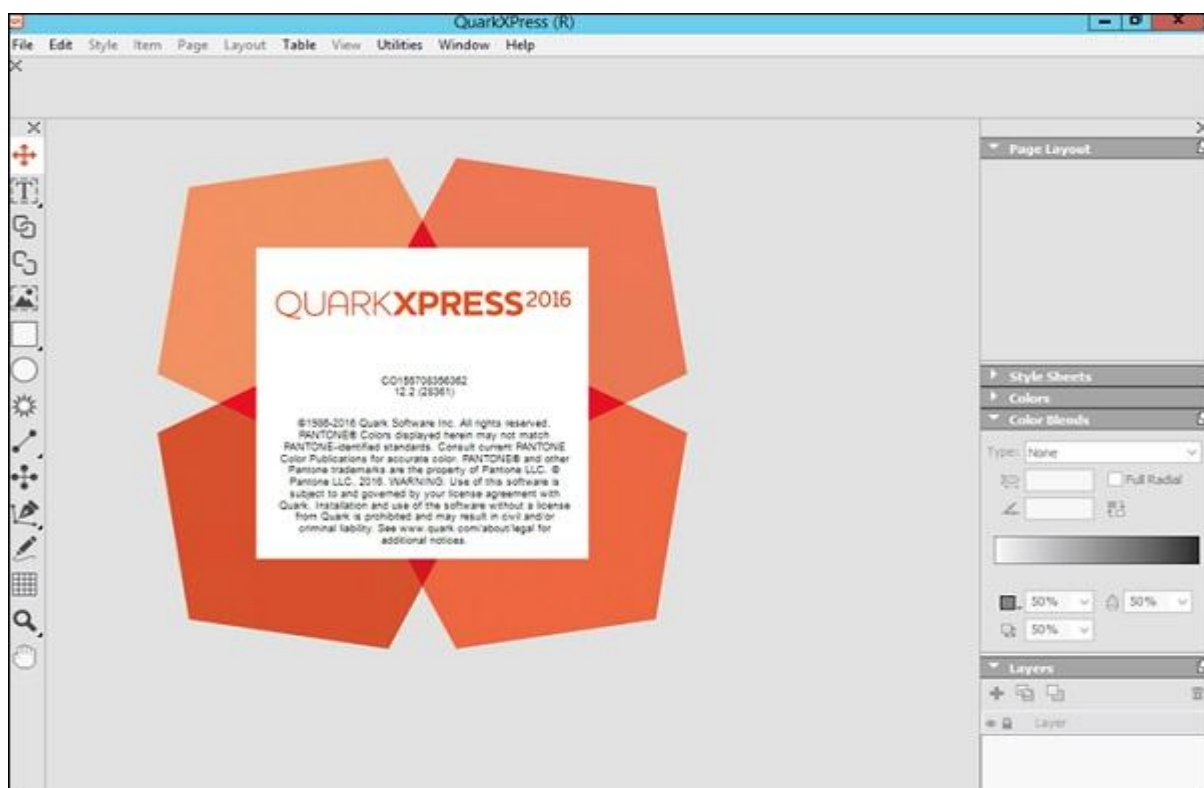
Microsoft publisher interface



PagePlus interface



Adobe PageMaker interface



QuarkXpress interface

## **kinds of Desktop publishing software's**

There are 2 main kind of DTP software:

**1). Graphical based:** They are specifically developed for editing & formatting graphic objects like pictures. Graphic-based desktop publishers have superior capabilities for handling images such as setting resolution, brightness, contrast, cropping, and filling the images with colour. Examples include;

- Adobe Photoshop.
- Harvard graphic.
- CorelDraw.

**2). Layout based:** They are specifically developed to create different page layout designs for text and other typographic publications. Examples;

- Adobe PageMaker.
- Microsoft Publisher

## **Purpose of Desktop Publishing Software's**

DTP programs give the typesetter (the person designing publications) an ideal environment to:

**(a). Create Graphic design:** Using DTP software, a typesetter can create and edit very complex text & graphical objects of high quality. For example, the software provides the user with rulers & ruler guides that can be used to place an object in the correct position within the publication.

**(b). Create Page layout design:** With a desktop publisher, the user can design a page layout by setting consistent (constant) picture and object locations, divide a page into a number of columns, and also create *layers*.

- *Layering* is the arrangement of objects on top of each other with the object on top regarded as the first layer.
- *Why layering* is important is that It keeps objects separate and logically organized. In complex documents there can be many different objects overlapping each other, and manipulating them becomes error prone without some handy way to isolate them.

**(c). Print Publications:** To produce any publications, they must be printed. Therefore, DTP software helps the user to prepare artwork (i.e., publications that are ready for printing).

## **Types of publications**

There are several types of publications that can be produced using DTP software. They include:

**Cards:** They may be for special occasions such as weddings, graduations, harambee, and for congratulations.

**Certificates:** These are types of publications used to show completion of courses and special events. *Note;* Certificates are very sensitive, and must be designed to discourage any type of duplication or counterfeits.

**Newspapers, Magazines, Pamphlets and Newsletters:** They contain news targeting a group of people.

**Books:** Are bulky publications with many pages that are bound together that has a title and chapters in it..

**Calendars:** They are used to show dates. They are also used by companies to advertise their products.

**Newsletter:** A form that is sent outside the business to clients on a regular basis to indicate company services and provide information.

**Notices, Brochures, Posters / Advertisement, and Catalogues.**

**Flyers** - A promotional poster used for various informational purposes.

**Features of DTP software.**

- Text can be entered directly into a DTP publication. Alternatively, the text can be entered into a Word processor and then copied into the DTP document.
- Graphics can be created in a separate program, then incorporated into a Desktop publishing program.
- A Scanner can also be used to copy images, such as photographs and drawings, into a Desktop publishing document. A Scanner is a device that reads text and images into a document.

A DTP program gives you more control over the graphics in a publication. You can:

**Move** – change the position of a graphic on a page,

**Size** – make a graphic larger or smaller,

**Rotate** – turn or spin a graphic, and

**Crop** – trim part of a graphic.

- Has a wide range of Fonts & print sizes that can be merged with useful symbols, such as arrows and stars.
- Has Columns of various widths, in which the text is fitted automatically using sensible hyphenation. The columns can also be reorganization automatically.
- Enables Scaling and cropping of publications so as to fit the available space.
- Page numbers can be inserted.
- Enables production of multiple page documents.

**Steps in Using a DTP System.**

1. Prepare your text and illustrations with a **Word processor** or a **Graphics package**.

Alternatively, use a **Scanner** to input text and graphics from other sources.

2. Using the DTP program, develop the format of each page.

Your screen becomes an electronic paste board with rulers, column guides and other page design aids.

3. Copy the text and illustrations into the page format you have designed in the DTP program.

The DTP program will automatically move the excess text to another column or page and also help size and place illustrations and headings.

4. Format the pages on the screen to look the way you want them, then store them electronically on your hard disk. If necessary, print them on a Laser Printer to produce the finished printed material.

**Difference between a desktop publisher and a word processor.**

A DTP software gives the user more tools and control of the page layout, text manipulation and graphic design than a **word processor**. However, today's word processors have been incorporated with text and graphic formatting and editing tools, e.g., you can design a full publication in Microsoft Word by using the available Drawing and Picture tools, create columns, **Microsoft actually does have a DTP app, but Word is not it.**

## **Terminologies Used in DTP.**

**Ranner** – the main headline across the top of the page.

**Cross head** – a small heading used to break up text into easily readable sections.

**Dialog box** - A list of options that appear after you have clicked on a menu, or button, e.g. if you click on the SAVE button a dialog box will appear asking where you want to save your file and what you want to call it, etc.

**Bullet** – solid dot printed before pieces of text in order to add an emphasis.

**Border** - A line or frame surrounding graphics, graphs, illustrations, photographs, text, etc. that defines the edges.

**Caption** - Text used to describe an illustration or photograph

**Cast off** – a calculation as to how much space the text will use on a page.

**Element** - A unit (illustration/graphic or type/text) to be used in a publication

**Fill** - The fill is the inside of the object. An object can like a rectangle, circle, etc can have no-fill or be filled with colour, texture, pattern or picture.

**Footer** – a line of text at the bottom of each page giving the publications title, author's name,

**Kerning** - kerning is the process of adjusting the spacing between characters in a proportional font, usually to achieve a visually pleasing result.

**Layout** - Arrangement of elements (graphics and text) on a page.

**Landscape** - page orientation, the width is greater than the height and so often referred to as wide

**Masthead** – details of the person involved in printing the publication.

**WYSIWYG** (What You See Is What You Get) – this means that, the presentation on the screen is exactly what you will get from the Printer.

**Jigging** – moving text around by means of DTP software.

**Publication** - a file created in a DTP program is called a publication.

**Tracking** – Tracking refers to adjustment of the amount of space between the letters of an entire word in equal increments.

**Watermark** - an impression incorporated in the paper making process showing the name of the paper and/or the company logo. In desktop publishing a watermark is simply a background text or graphic image.